

music. It's great to set up some old computer as the MPD server and route that music throughout your network. The advantage lies in the fact that it will require less space for storage—everyone has their own account and they can listen to whatever music they want to as long as it is on the server (or optionally, on your local machine).

Unless you are using Linux from Scratch or Rock Linux, your distribution repositories have the binaries for MPD. Install MPD and copy the file `/etc/mpd.conf.example` to `/etc/mpd.conf`. Open it in any preferred text editor. And then configure MPD as follows.

Edit the file and add the following lines—this is the most basic and simple, single-user configuration for MPD that we will use with Icecast:

```
music_directory "/home/user/music" # Your music dir.
playlist_directory "/var/lib/mpd/playlists"
db_file "/var/lib/mpd/db"
log_file "/var/log/mpd/mpd.log"
error_file "/var/log/mpd/mpd.error"
pid_file "/var/run/mpd/mpd.pid"
state_file "/var/lib/mpd/mpdstate"
user "mpd"

# Binding to address and port causing problems
# in mpd-0.14.2 best to leave commented.
# bind_to_address "127.0.0.1"
# port "6600"

audio_output {
    type "alsa"
    name "My ALSA Device"
    device "hw:0,0" # optional
    format "44100:16:2" # optional
}

# We assume that you use ALSA in this config.
# If you are using any other driver, please visit the
# official docs at http://mpd.wikia.com/wiki/Configuration
```

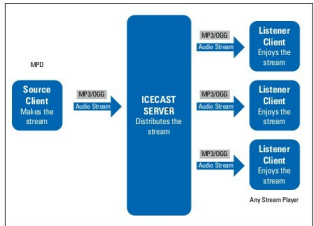


Figure 1: An overview of the streaming server

to know how to setup your driver.

Most of the fields in the configuration file above are self-explanatory. You only need to change the music directory to your music directory path. Keep the other paths and even the user as mpd. We will get back to that later. Save the file for now. Come back to the root console.

Let's create a new user, mpd, which will be used to access MPD.

```
useradd -g mpd -d /var/lib/mpd
```

Then make sure that the directory is owned by the mpd user, as well as the mpd group, by issuing the following command:

```
chown mpd:mpd /var/lib/mpd -R
```

Moving along, we now have to create the files mentioned earlier, and then transfer ownership of some files and directories to mpd:mpd. Execute the following commands.

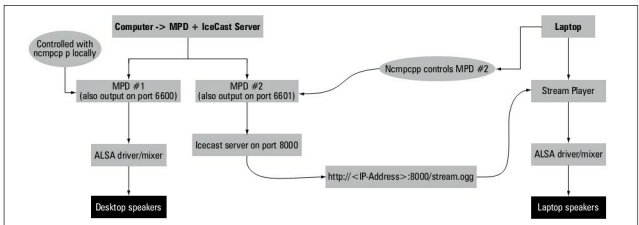


Figure 2: How the streaming server works